File reviewed: nirf_tableau_ready_cleaned_v2.csv (provided attachment)

Comparison baseline: data/raw/nirf_rankings_2017_2025_clean.csv and the current processed dataset.

Executive summary

Do not replace the current dashboard dataset directly with the attached CSV. The attached file has a different schema and category set. A key-based comparison found all 6,734 existing ranking rows; all scores and numeric ranks match the current clean master on those rows. However, the attachment has one confirmed rank-withdrawal flag error, four records without the original Institute ID, reused raw source UIDs, and significant display-name and location differences that need review.

- No input or project dataset was changed while preparing this report.
- Most flagged null scores are explicitly explained by source statuses (rank-only listings, special mentions, or a withdrawn record), not unexplained numeric score errors.
- States are consistent: 33 canonical names, no casing-only duplicates, and no state-name mismatches on the 6,734 matched records.

Dataset profile

- Attached CSV: 6,980 rows, 50 columns, years 2017-2025, 18 category labels.
- Current clean master / dashboard: 6,734 ranking rows, 12 categories, years 2017-2025.
- Attached composite scores: 6,923 present (57 null), range 30.31-94.46; no scores outside 0-100.
- The 6,734 overlap is matched by Year + Institute ID / Institute_ID_Original, with category aliases Research Institutions -> Research and Architecture & Planning -> Architecture.
- Within the matched rows: 6,703 non-null scores are exactly equal; all null-score positions and all numeric ranks also agree.

Severity guide

High = can misstate rank eligibility. Medium = identity/integration ambiguity or inconsistent labels needing review. Informational = expected missingness or additional data not present in the current dashboard schema.

Findings requiring correction or review

HIGH - A withdrawn rank is incorrectly marked usable

For Dental, 2025, Faculty of Dental Sciences, Institute of Medical Sciences (Institution UID N-71), the clean master marks Rank_Status = Rank Withdrawn and Score_Status = Withdrawn. In the attachment, Analytical Rank is 18, Rank Label is 18, Is Rank Withdrawn is False, Rank Usable for Analysis is True, and Rank Validation Status is Single Distinct Rank. This can incorrectly include a withdrawn rank in rank comparisons and ranking charts. The other withdrawn row (Bishop Heber College, College, 2018) is marked withdrawn correctly.

MEDIUM - Four Special Mention rows cannot be joined by Institute ID

All four 2018 Special Mention records have a blank Institute ID and no score or rank: ICAR - National Dairy Research Institute; Indian Agricultural Research Institute; Jawaharlal Nehru Centre for Advanced Scientific Research; Tata Institute of Fundamental Research. These appear to be recognition-only rows, not scored rankings, but they cannot participate in ID-based merges without a reviewed crosswalk.

MEDIUM - Two reused Raw Institution UID values identify different colleges

Raw UID C-35787 is used for Holy Cross College, Tiruchirappalli and Holy Cross College, Nagercoil in 2017. Raw UID I-1323 is used for St. Josephs College, Devagiri and St. Josephs College, Irinjalakuda in 2017. The attachment assigns distinct Institution UID values, so its transformed identity key avoids conflating these records; the raw-source identifier reuse should still be checked against its provenance.

MEDIUM - Institution labels and city values differ from the current master

Among 6,734 ID-matched rows, 911 have a different Standardized Institution Name and 401 have a different Standardized Location versus the current master Institution_Name and City. These may reflect different canonicalization rules, not necessarily incorrect identity matches, but the differences affect displayed labels, text matching, and map placement. State values match in all 6,734 rows.

Examples of label and location differences

Attached standardized name	Current master name
Atma Ram Sanatan Dharm College	Atma Ram Sanatan Dharma College
St. Xavier’s College, Kolkata	St. Xavier’s College
Fatima College	Fatima College (Autonomous)
Shri M.V. & Smt. N.V. Virani Science College	Shri M.V. and Smt. N.V. Virani Science Col
Holy Cross College, Tiruchirappalli	Holy Cross College

These examples illustrate that some name differences are spelling, punctuation, suffix, or campus detail. The institution IDs still align in the comparison, and scores match; choose and document one display-name policy before replacing the dashboard source.

Example city differences on matched institutions

Attached standardized location	Current master city
New Delhi	Delhi
Virudhunagar	Virudhnagar
Mayiladuthurai	Chennai
District Trichur	Thrissur
Mangaluru	Dakshina Kannada

The Mayiladuthurai versus Chennai discrepancy is potentially substantive, not just capitalization. Review city-level differences before using the attachment for geospatial or city-level analysis. State-level values did match.

Additional rows and schema compatibility

The attachment adds 242 ID-bearing rows outside the current 12-category master, plus the four no-ID Special Mention rows (246 additional rows total). The added categories are Agriculture & Allied Sectors (120), State Public University (100), Sustainable Development Goals (SDG) (10), Open University (6), Skill University (6), and Special Mention (2018) (4). The project does not currently have equivalent analysis configuration for these categories. Identity columns differ: Institution UID (941 distinct values) is not the dashboard Institution_ID. The crosswalk used for the 6,734-row score/rank comparison is Institute ID to Institute_ID_Original, along with Year and category aliases. The attachment contains 2,183 distinct non-null Institute ID values and four blank values; the dashboard analysis expects its own stable institution_id and established lowercase column names.

Checks that passed

- Primary row key: no duplicates in (Year, Category, Institution UID). Non-null Institute ID keys are unique within Year and Category; the four blank Institute IDs are not joinable.
- Identity consistency: 941 distinct Institution UID values map to one standardized name each; no standardized name maps to multiple Institution UID values in the attachment.
- State consistency: exactly 33 distinct canonical state/UT names; no case-only duplicate state names; all matched state values equal the current master.
- Score domain: every populated Composite Score is between 0 and 100. TLR, RPC, GO, OI, Perception, and research parameter fields also have no values outside 0-100.
- Score missingness (57 rows): 30 Innovation rank-only records; 6 Open University and 6 Skill University rank-only records; 10 SDG rank-only records; 4 Special Mention records; 1 Dental record with an omitted/withdrawn score. No missing composite score was found without a data-quality explanation.
- Overall row counts: 100 per year except 2020, which has 101 due to a tie.
- Year-over-year arithmetic: 5,229 populated rank-change values equal previous rank minus current rank; 5,211 populated score-change values equal current score minus prior-year score (within floating-point tolerance). The previous-year-record flag agrees with the ID/category/year lookup.

Interpretation and recommendation

The attachment appears score-compatible with the current dashboard for the 6,734 existing records. It is not a drop-in replacement: first fix or confirm the 2025 Dental withdrawn-rank status, decide whether and how to assign IDs to the four Special Mention rows, validate the two reused raw UIDs and location/name differences, and explicitly map the six added category labels into the dashboard schema. Keep the current clean master as the source until these decisions are approved and the rebuild/tests pass.

Method and limitations

This is a read-only file audit performed on 6 Nov 2026. Comparison used exact Year + Institute ID / Institute_ID_Original and the two stated category aliases; no fuzzy name matching was used. Checks cover row/ID uniqueness, nulls, score bounds, state values, rank status, and selected derived year-over-year fields. A difference from the current master is evidence of disagreement, not by itself proof of which source is authoritative. Original NIRF publications were not independently re-verified in this audit.